

Rimjhim Saxena

Postdoctoral Researcher, Geneva School of Economics and Management (University of Geneva)

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Geneva

Sept 2025 - Present

Institute of Economics and Econometrics
Geneva School of Economics and Management

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of Colorado Boulder

2025

Disseration: "Three Essays in the Economics of Climate Change

Advisor: Jonathan Edward Hughes, Committee: Daniel Kaffine, Taylor Jaworski, Beia Spiller

M.A. Economics, University of Colorado Boulder

2021

M.A. Economics, Boston University

2017

M.B.A. Finance, Thapar Institute of Engineering & Technology

2014

B.E. Industrial Engineering, Thapar Institute of Engineering & Technology

2014

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Primary: Environmental Economics, Economics of Climate Change, International Trade, Development Economics

Secondary: Applied Microeconomics, Political Economics,

WORKING PAPERS

1. *Barriers within Borders: Climate Change, Market Barriers, and the Reversal of Structural Transformation* (Job Market Paper)*
2. *Stumped by the sun, Saved by the side: Estimating the role of peer and adversarial effects in adaptation to heat* *

* abstracts at the end

WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. *Quantifying global trade leakage under the EUDR policy* (with [Matthieu Stigler](#))
 2. *Climate Change and Mechanization of Agriculture in India* (with [Bhavya Srivastava](#))
 3. *Climate Change and Informal Insurance Networks* (with [Matthew Gordon](#))
 4. *Energy cost pass through in Indian Manufacturing firms* (with [Johannes Gálle](#))
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PUBLICATIONS

BOOK CHAPTER

Chatterjee, D., Lal, B., & Saxena, R. (2021). [Education: Understanding the Gender Gap in Education and Employment](#). In S. Chakravorty & N. Sircar (Eds.), *Colossus: The Anatomy of Delhi* (South Asia in the Social Sciences, pp. 273-289). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. [doi:10.1017/9781108935654.013](#)

OTHER WRITING

Arora, K., Saxena, R. (2018). [India-China Economic Relations: An Assessment](#). *South Asian Voices, Stimson Center*, Washington D.C

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Colorado Boulder

Instructor of Record: Natural Resource Economics (~50 students) Aug 2024 - Dec 2024

Instructor of Record: Principles of Microeconomics (~200 students) Aug 2022 - Dec 2022

Managed a team of four teaching assistants

Teaching Assistant Aug 2019 - May 2025

Principles of Microeconomics (x5 semesters)

Principles of Macroeconomics (x4 semesters)

Environmental Economics (x2 semesters)

Introduction to Statistics with Computer Applications (x1 semester)

AWARDS

Heartland Environmental and Resource Economics Workshop Travel Support, 2023

TWEEDS workshop Travel Grant, 2023 (\$525)

Faculty Support Fellowship, 2023 (\$515)

Graduate School Domestic Travel Grant, 2023 (\$450)

Graduate Award for Public Policy Research, 2022 (\$2,000)

Reuben A. Zubrow Fellowship in Economics, 2021 (\$2,000)

Continuing Education Teaching Fellowship, University of Colorado Boulder, 2021 (\$2,000)

Continuing Education Teaching Fellowship, University of Colorado Boulder, 2020 (\$1,000)

Scholarship, Department of Economics, University of Colorado Boulder, 2019 (\$10,000)

SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2025: AERE Session at Eastern Economic Association Conference, New York NY; Seton Hall University; Truman State University; IIT Gandhinagar; AERE Summer Conference (*Scheduled*); GSEM, University of Geneva

2024: 25th Annual CU Environmental and Resource Economics Workshop, Vail CO; DARE Seminar at Colorado State University; AERE Session at Southern Economic Association Conference, Washington D.C.

2023: 18th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, Indian Statistical Institute, Delhi; Heartland Environmental and Resource Economics Workshop; 2023 Berkeley/Sloan Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics; 98th Western Economic Association Conference; AERE Summer Conference; 12th Annual Front Range Energy and Environmental Economics Camp

2022: 23rd Annual CU Environmental and Resource Economics Workshop; 11th Annual Front Range Energy and Environmental Economics Camp

2021: Environmental Defense Fund

2019: Centre for Policy Research

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE)

Organizing Committee, AERE sessions at Southern Economic Conference 2024

Session Chair, AERE sessions at Southern Economic Conference 2024

University of Colorado Boulder

Organizer, Economics Graduate Student Seminar 2021 - 2025

Host, Graduate Student Panel at Graduate Student Recruitment Spring 2024

Mentor, Graduate student Mentor (x2) 2021 - 2023

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (AERE), Western Economic Association International (WEAI)

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Colorado Boulder

Research Assistant (Dr. Taylor Jaworski) May 2022 - July 2022

Digitized manufacturing plant opening locations in US during World War II
Created data visualizations, and spatial equilibrium model

Research Assistant (Dr. Francisca Antman) May 2020 - July 2020

Antman, F. M., & Cortes, K. E. (2023). The Long-Run Impacts of Mexican American School Desegregation. *Journal of Economic Literature*, 61(3), 888-905.

Environmental Defense Fund

Pre Doctoral Fellow June 2021 - Aug 2021

Under Office of the Chief Economist
Collaborated with Economics, Science, Policy teams in USA and India on research on Economic impacts of Environment, and Environmental justice questions

University of Pennsylvania

Research Associate, Centre for Advanced Study of India (CASI) Jan 2018 - July 2019

In collaboration with Centre for Policy Research (CPR), Delhi

Vaishanv, Milan (2021). [Gender, social change, and urbanisation in North India](#). *International Growth Centre Project #IND-19069*

Khosla, R., Sircar, N., & Bhardwaj, A. (2019). Energy demand transitions and climate mitigation in low-income urban households in India. *Environmental Research Letters*, 14(9), 095008.

Bhardwaj, A., Joshi, M., Khosla, R., & Dubash, N. K. (2019). More priorities, more problems? Decision-making with multiple energy, development and climate objectives. *Energy Research & Social Science*, 49, 143-157.

[Small City Dreaming Project](#), Centre for Policy Research

SKILLS

Proficient: R, Julia, Quarto Markdown, GIS Tools, L^AT_EX, C, C#

Intermediate: Python, Stata, Matlab, SQL

Languages: English (Native), Hindi (Native), Urdu, Punjabi

REFERENCES

Jonathan Edward Hughes (advisor)

Department of Economics

256 UCB

Boulder, CO 80309

Email:jonathan.e.hughes@colorado.edu

Daniel Kaffine (committee member)

Department of Economics

256 UCB

Boulder, CO 80309

Email:daniel.kaffine@colorado.edu

Taylor Jaworski (committee member)

Department of Economics

256 UCB

Boulder, CO 80309

Email:taylor.jaworski@colorado.edu

Beia Spiller (committee member)

Transportation Program Director

Resources for the Future

Washington DC, 20036

Email:bspiller@rff.org

ABSTRACTS

1. *Barriers within Borders: Climate Change, Market Barriers, and the Reversal of Structural Transformation* (Job Market Paper)

This paper examines how climate change is hindering structural transformation in India and the role of internal trade barriers in exacerbating the effect. I combine local temperature effects on productivity, consumption, and labor shares to evaluate the potential for labor reallocation out of agriculture as an adaptation to climate change. Empirical findings show that temperature has a more negative impact on agricultural productivity versus manufacturing (supply-side effect), and household expenditure on food increases as incomes fall, consistent with Engel's law (demand-side effect). Overall, in equilibrium, rising temperatures increase the agricultural labor share. Therefore hindering structural transformation. Theoretically, districts in India could mitigate against the adverse effects of declining agricultural productivity through inter-district trade with less affected districts. Using a market access variable created by using development of Indian highways, I find that improved market access does not disrupt the positive relationship between temperature and agricultural labor share due to existing barriers in trade within India. These trade barriers reduce spatial competition among agricultural buyers and traps labor in low-productivity agriculture. I then use a spatial equilibrium model with internal trade barriers for counterfactual analysis which reveals that removing state-level trade barriers in Indian agriculture would decrease agricultural labor share by 11.05% on average for each district (~ 28.9 million people across India).

2. *Stumped by the sun, Saved by the side: Estimating the role of peer and adversarial effects in adaptation to heat*

Literature has conclusively established that temperature has negative impact on individual's labor productivity. However we rarely work in isolation, most jobs require working with peers or against an adversary. This paper provides first estimates of the magnitude of peer and adversarial effect on individual's productivity under heat. Utilizing rich data, institutional details, and team dynamics of the sport of cricket, I find that even though temperature affects individual's productivity negatively, it doesn't have any effect on equilibrium outcomes that are affected by peers and adversaries. There could only be two explanations for this: increased peer effect under heat or a decreased adversarial effect. A further analysis reveals that peer effect increases significantly at temperature above 25C while adversarial effect has no significant difference between games played below 25C and above 25C temperature. These peer effects accrue through complementarity of skill-set among peers which creates opportunity for learning at higher temperature. This finding shows that even when workers are individually affected negatively by temperature, they can adapt in team settings through positive peer effect given complementary skills exist among peers.